# SIMATS ENGINEERING
## ASSESSMENT TOOL 1

**COURSE NAME: Artificial Intelligence** **COURSE CODE: CSA17**

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**COURSE OUTCOME COVERED**

***CO2:*** *Experiment search and game-solving techniques such as Greedy Search, A*, CSP, Minimax, and Alpha-Beta pruning with heuristic functions for solving complex AI problems efficiently. (BL3)*

*Assessment Tool Weightage: 35%*

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**Duration: 1 Hour**

**QUESTIONS: 5** **Total Marks:50**

Annexure A

**Scenario Based Assignment**

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***Code of Conduct:***

*I _____ (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment.*
*I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.*

***Signature of the student:***

Annexure A

## Scenario Based Assignment

**1. Scenario** : A government deploys AI-powered drones to deliver emergency medicines in a flood-affected region. The environment is highly dynamic—roads may suddenly become inaccessible, and weather conditions affect travel cost. The drone has access to: A heuristic estimate (straight-line distance), Partial real-time updates about blocked paths and Variable movement costs depending on terrain and weather. However, due to urgency, the drone must quickly decide routes with minimum delay and risk.

Tasks:

i. Explain how Greedy Best-First Search would behave in this scenario and discuss its strengths and weaknesses under uncertainty

ii. Explain how A* would handle the same situation, including how it balances cost and heuristic

iii. Analyze the impact of heuristic accuracy on both algorithms

iv. Discuss how dynamic changes (blocked paths) affect search performance

v. Recommend the most suitable algorithm and justify your decision considering real-time constraints, optimality, and safety

2. **Scenario**: A smart city implements an AI system to optimize traffic signal timings across hundreds of intersections. The objective is to minimize Total waiting time, Fuel consumption and Traffic congestion. The system must continuously adjust signals based on traffic flow. However the search space is extremely large, traffic patterns change dynamically and the system may get stuck in locally optimal solutions

**Tasks.** Formulate this as an optimization problem and explain why traditional search is inefficient

i. Explain how Hill Climbing would work in this scenario and identify its limitations

ii. Discuss issues like local maxima, plateaus, and ridges with real-world interpretation

iii. Explain how Simulated Annealing or Genetic Algorithms can overcome these limitations

iv. Recommend the best approach and justify your choice based on scalability and adaptability

3. **Scenario:** An autonomous rover is deployed on Mars to explore unknown terrain. It must: navigate safely to collect samples, avoid hazards (craters, rocks), operate with limited sensing capability and make decisions without a complete map. The rover updates its knowledge as it explores, making this a real-time decision-making problem.

Tasks:

i. Explain why this problem requires an online search agent instead of offline search

ii. Analyze the challenges of partial observability and dynamic environments

iii. Describe how the rover builds and updates its internal model

iv. Compare online search with uninformed and informed search strategies

v. Justify the most suitable approach considering uncertainty, adaptability, and safety

4. **Scenario:** A university is designing an AI system to automatically generate exam timetables. The system must satisfy multiple constraints: No student should have overlapping exams, Limited number of exam halls, Certain subjects must be scheduled before others, Faculty availability constraints, Special accommodations for some students, The complexity increases as the number of courses and students grows.

Tasks :

Formulate the problem as a Constraint Satisfaction Problem (CSP)

i. Clearly define variables, domains, and constraints with explanation

ii. Explain how backtracking search works in this scenario

iii. Discuss how constraint propagation (e.g., forward checking) improves efficiency

iv. Analyze real-world challenges and justify the best strategy for scalability

5. **Scenario:** Strategic Game AI for Real-Time Decision Making (Minimax & Alpha-Beta Pruning) A gaming company is developing an AI opponent for a real-time strategy game. The AI must complete against human players, Make decisions within strict time limits, Evaluate complex game states with multiple possible moves, The decision tree is extremely large, making computation expensive.

Tasks:

i. Explain how the Minimax algorithm models this problem

ii. Analyze the computational challenges of large game trees

iii. Explain how Alpha-Beta pruning improves efficiency with detailed reasoning

iv. Design an evaluation function and justify the factors considered

v. Recommend a strategy for balancing optimality and real-time performance

## RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION

| Criteria | Weightage (%) | Level 4 (Exemplary) | Level 3 (Proficient) | Level 2 (Developing) | Level 1 (Beginning) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Understanding of Scenario | 20% | Demonstrates clear and complete understanding of the scenario and context | Shows good understanding with minor gaps | Partial understanding; misses key aspects | Misinterprets or fails to understand the scenario |
| Identification of Key Issues | 20% | Accurately identifies all relevant issues and factors involved | Identifies most key issues with minor omissions | Identifies limited issues; some irrelevant points | Unable to identify key issues |
| Application of Concepts | 25% | Applies appropriate concepts effectively to address the scenario | Applies concepts with minor errors | Limited or partially correct application | Unable to apply relevant concepts |
| Decision Making | 20% | Makes well-reasoned, logical decisions with strong rationale | Makes reasonable decisions with some justification | Makes weak decisions with limited justification | No clear decisions made or rationale provided |
| Clarity of Response | 15% | Response is clear, structured, and logically presented | Generally clear with minor issues | Somewhat unclear or poorly structured | Disorganized and difficult to understand |